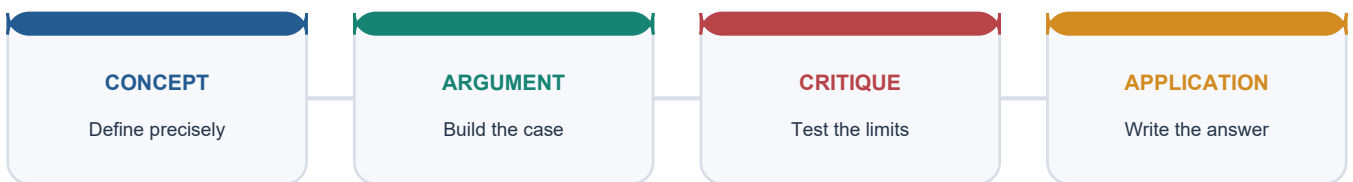


## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# State, Civil Society, Nation and Internationalism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

### LEARNING PATH



*Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.*

---

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

# CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

|                                                                                     |          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>State, Civil Society, Nation and Internationalism - Solved Practice Workbook</b> | <b>4</b> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|

|                       |          |
|-----------------------|----------|
| <b>WORKBOOK GUIDE</b> | <b>4</b> |
|-----------------------|----------|

|                                 |          |
|---------------------------------|----------|
| <b>BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION</b> | <b>4</b> |
|---------------------------------|----------|

|                   |    |
|-------------------|----|
| Practice design   | 4  |
| MCQ 1             | 4  |
| MCQ 2             | 5  |
| MCQ 3             | 5  |
| MCQ 4             | 5  |
| MCQ 5             | 6  |
| MCQ 6             | 6  |
| MCQ 7             | 7  |
| MCQ 8             | 7  |
| MCQ 9             | 7  |
| MCQ 10            | 8  |
| MCQ 11            | 9  |
| MCQ 12            | 9  |
| MCQ 13            | 10 |
| MCQ 14            | 10 |
| MCQ 15            | 11 |
| MCQ 16            | 11 |
| MCQ 17            | 12 |
| MCQ 18            | 12 |
| MCQ 19            | 13 |
| MCQ 20            | 13 |
| MCQ 21            | 14 |
| MCQ 22            | 14 |
| MCQ 23            | 15 |
| MCQ 24            | 15 |
| MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL | 16 |

|                                                           |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 16        |
| MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 17        |
| MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 17        |
| MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 18        |
| MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 18        |
| MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 19        |
| MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL . . . . .                               | 19        |
| <b>PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE . . . . .</b>                 | <b>20</b> |
| VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS . . . . .     | 20        |
| ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS . . . . . | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 20        |
| Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks . . . . .            | 21        |
| Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 21        |
| Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 22        |
| Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks . . . . .            | 23        |

# State, Civil Society, Nation and Internationalism - Solved Practice Workbook

**Subject:** Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

## WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 10 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

### MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **State**?

- A. A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- B. the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.
- C. accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
- D. A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for State.
- **B:** B Attaches to MacIver, not State.
- **C:** C Attaches to Marx, not State.
- **D:** D Attaches to Internationalism, not State.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify State by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Government**?

- A. Community bound by political unity, common history and common destiny. (PDF pp.157-158)
- B. Operating agency of the state.
- C. Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.
- D. The social fact that multiple religions coexist.

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Nation, not Government.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Government.
- **C:** C Attaches to Society, not Government.
- **D:** D Attaches to Religious pluralism, not Government.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Government by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Society**?

- A. Community bound by political unity, common history and common destiny.
- B. The social fact that multiple religions coexist.
- C. Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.
- D. Operating agency of the state.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Nation, not Society.
- **B:** B Attaches to Religious pluralism, not Society.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Society.
- **D:** D Attaches to Government, not Society.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Society by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Nation**?

- A. The social fact that multiple religions coexist.
- B. saw voluntary associations as counterweights to state power and schools of democracy.
- C. Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.
- D. Community bound by political unity, common history and common destiny.

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Religious pluralism, not Nation.
- **B:** B Attaches to Tocqueville, not Nation.
- **C:** C Attaches to Society, not Nation.

- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Nation.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Nation by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Nationality**?

- A. A feeling of unity often based on race, language, religion, culture, compactness and common historical development.
- B. Both a sentiment of attachment to one's nation and an ideology that political organization should rest on nationhood.
- C. The existence of two or more culturally distinctive groups within one society (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.148).
- D. The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Nationality.
- **B:** B Attaches to Nationalism, not Nationality.
- **C:** C Attaches to Multiculturalism (descriptive), not Nationality.
- **D:** D Attaches to Sovereignty, not Nationality.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Nationality by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Civil society**?

- A. treated civil society as structures of legitimation and political society as structures of coercion, together forming structures of domination.
- B. In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older meanings where it was equated with the state. (PDF pp.154-155, 173-176)
- C. dense networks of civic associational life generate "social capital" - norms of reciprocity and trust - which make collective action easier and improve the.
- D. Positive recognition of cultural difference, minority identity and the value of diversity (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF pp.148-154).

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Gramsci, not Civil society.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Civil society.
- **C:** C Attaches to Robert Putnam - claim, not Civil society.
- **D:** D Attaches to Multiculturalism (normative), not Civil society.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Civil society by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Sovereignty**?

- A. Gauba traces the modern concept of the state to Machiavelli's focus on the power having authority over men.
- B. A feeling of unity often based on race, language, religion, culture, compactness and common historical development.
- C. The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.
- D. Both a sentiment of attachment to one's nation and an ideology that political organization should rest on nationhood.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Machiavelli, not Sovereignty.
- **B:** B Attaches to Nationality, not Sovereignty.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Sovereignty.
- **D:** D Attaches to Nationalism, not Sovereignty.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Sovereignty by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Nationalism**?

- A. A feeling of unity often based on race, language, religion, culture, compactness and common historical development.
- B. The existence of two or more culturally distinctive groups within one society (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.148).
- C. accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
- D. Both a sentiment of attachment to one's nation and an ideology that political organization should rest on nationhood.

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Nationality, not Nationalism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Multiculturalism (descriptive), not Nationalism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Marx, not Nationalism.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Nationalism.

**Examiner trap:** Do not identify Nationalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

### MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Internationalism - A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.
- B. MacIver - the modern state is defined sociologically by its successful claim to the monopoly of legitimate physical force within a territory.
- C. State - distinguished civil society as the sphere of self-interest from the state as a sphere of universality; he also idealized the state.

- D. Marx - Positive recognition of cultural difference, minority identity and the value of diversity (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF pp.148-154).

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Internationalism is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: MacIver is recorded with the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.
- **C:** C Misplaced: State is recorded with A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Marx is recorded with accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Internationalism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Jean Cohen and Andrew Arato - claim - treated civil society as structures of legitimation and political society as structures of coercion.
- B. Secularism - A non-theocratic political order that protects freedom and equality across religious difference. The supplied second source contrasts a separation-centred Western model with an Indian model allowing principled state engagement against religious domination (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF pp.144-146)
- C. Herbert Marcuse - claim - In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older.
- D. Laski (correction - not a monist) - dense networks of civic associational life generate "social capital" - norms of reciprocity and trust - which make.

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Jean Cohen and Andrew Arato - claim is recorded with civil society is a distinct third sphere of social life - associations, public sphere, social movements and culture - analytically separate from both the state and the economy, and it needs mediating institutions ("political society" - parties, parliaments; "economic society" - regulated markets, trade unions) to translate its demands into state and market outcomes.
- **B:** B Kept where the source puts it: Secularism is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Herbert Marcuse - claim is recorded with in One-Dimensional Man (1964), Marcuse argues advanced industrial society (capitalist or state-socialist) absorbs and neutralises potential opposition by satisfying manufactured consumer/material needs - a process he calls "repressive desublimation" - producing a "one-dimensional" society where genuine critical opposition is difficult to sustain.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Laski (correction - not a monist) is recorded with Gauba's page notes only that residence brings some obligation to the state (PDF p.149), but Laski's own, better-known position is the opposite of state monism: Laski is UPSC's standard pluralist critic of the claim that the state holds a single, morally supreme, all-encompassing sovereignty.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Secularism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Government - Gauba traces the modern concept of the state to Machiavelli's focus on the power.
- B. Society - saw voluntary associations as counterweights to state power and schools of democracy.
- C. Religious pluralism - The social fact that multiple religions coexist.
- D. Nation - The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory. (PDF p.152)

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Government is recorded with Operating agency of the state.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Society is recorded with Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.
- **C:** C Kept where the source puts it: Religious pluralism is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Nation is recorded with Community bound by political unity, common history and common destiny.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Religious pluralism; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Nationalism - A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- B. Marx - A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.
- C. Nationality - the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.
- D. Multiculturalism (descriptive) - The existence of two or more culturally distinctive groups within one society (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.148).

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Nationalism is recorded with Both a sentiment of attachment to one's nation and an ideology that political organization should rest on nationhood.
- **B:** B Not this pair: Marx is recorded with accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Nationality is recorded with A feeling of unity often based on race, language, religion, culture, compactness and common historical development.
- **D:** D Kept where the source puts it: Multiculturalism (descriptive) is associated with this proposition.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Multiculturalism (descriptive); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Multiculturalism (normative) - Positive recognition of cultural difference, minority identity and the value of diversity (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF pp.148-154)
- B. Max Weber - treated civil society as structures of legitimation and political society as structures of coercion, together forming structures of domination.
- C. Hegel - the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.
- D. Internationalism - A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Multiculturalism (normative) is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Max Weber is recorded with the modern state is defined sociologically by its successful claim to the monopoly of legitimate physical force within a territory.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Hegel is recorded with distinguished civil society as the sphere of self-interest from the state as a sphere of universality; he also idealized the state.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Internationalism is recorded with A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Multiculturalism (normative); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Sovereignty - The existence of two or more culturally distinctive groups within one society (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.148).
- B. Machiavelli - Gauba traces the modern concept of the state to Machiavelli's focus on the power having authority over men.
- C. Nationality - accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
- D. Nationalism - A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Sovereignty is recorded with The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.
- **B:** B Exact pair: Machiavelli is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Nationality is recorded with A feeling of unity often based on race, language, religion, culture, compactness and common historical development.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Nationalism is recorded with Both a sentiment of attachment to one's nation and an ideology that political organization should rest on nationhood.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Machiavelli; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Internationalism - A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- B. Hegel - the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.
- C. Max Weber - the modern state is defined sociologically by its successful claim to the monopoly of legitimate physical force within a territory.
- D. Multiculturalism (normative) - accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Internationalism is recorded with A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Hegel is recorded with distinguished civil society as the sphere of self-interest from the state as a sphere of universality; he also idealized the state.
- **C:** C Records the association: Max Weber is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Multiculturalism (normative) is recorded with Positive recognition of cultural difference, minority identity and the value of diversity (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF pp.148-154).

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to Max Weber; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Marx - The existence of two or more culturally distinctive groups within one society (Socio-Political Philosophy, PDF p.148).
- B. State - the modern state is defined sociologically by its successful claim to the monopoly of legitimate physical force within a territory.
- C. Internationalism - distinguished civil society as the sphere of self-interest from the state as a sphere of universality; he also idealized the state.
- D. MacIver - the state embraces the whole people in a territory and acts through government as the organ that speaks with the voice of law.

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Marx is recorded with accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: State is recorded with A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Internationalism is recorded with A view that mankind needs larger cooperative organizations and reasonable restraints on sovereignty for common human interests.
- **D:** D Source-exact: MacIver is associated with this proposition.

**Examiner trap:** Keep the exact proposition attached to MacIver; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

### MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Laski (correction - not a monist)** is associated with: Gauba's page notes only that residence brings some obligation to the state (PDF p.149), but Laski's own, better-known position is the opposite of state monism: Laski is UPSC's standard pluralist critic of the claim that the state holds a single, morally supreme, all-encompassing sovereignty.
2. **Gramsci** is associated with: in *One-Dimensional Man* (1964), Marcuse argues advanced industrial society (capitalist or state-socialist) absorbs and neutralises potential opposition by satisfying manufactured consumer/material needs - a process he calls "repressive desublimation" - producing a "one-dimensional" society where genuine critical opposition is difficult to sustain

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Laski (correction - not a monist) does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Hegel** is associated with: saw voluntary associations as counterweights to state power and schools of democracy.
2. **Tocqueville** is associated with: saw voluntary associations as counterweights to state power and schools of democracy.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Hegel does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Marx** is associated with: accepted Hegel's description of civil society as economic sphere, but treated law and state as serving the capitalist class.
2. **Robert Putnam - claim** is associated with: dense networks of civic associational life generate "social capital" - norms of reciprocity and trust - which make collective action easier and improve the actual performance of democratic institutions.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Marx does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gramsci** is associated with: civil society is a distinct third sphere of social life - associations, public sphere, social movements and culture - analytically separate from both the state and the economy, and it needs mediating institutions ("political society" - parties, parliaments; "economic society" - regulated markets, trade unions) to translate its demands into state and market outcomes.
2. **Jean Cohen and Andrew Arato - claim** is associated with: Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gramsci does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Tocqueville** is associated with: saw voluntary associations as counterweights to state power and schools of democracy.
2. **Herbert Marcuse - claim** is associated with: Community bound by political unity, common history and common destiny.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Tocqueville does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Robert Putnam - claim** is associated with: A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
2. **State** is associated with: A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Robert Putnam - claim does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Jean Cohen and Andrew Arato - claim** is associated with: civil society is a distinct third sphere of social life - associations, public sphere, social movements and culture - analytically separate from both the state and the economy, and it needs mediating institutions ("political society" - parties, parliaments; "economic society" - regulated markets, trade unions) to translate its demands into state and market outcomes.
2. **Government** is associated with: Operating agency of the state.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Jean Cohen and Andrew Arato - claim does not validate the second pairing.

### MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Herbert Marcuse - claim** is associated with: Wider web of social relations meeting all human needs.
2. **Society** is associated with: The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

**Examiner trap:** Test each statement independently; familiarity with Herbert Marcuse - claim does not validate the second pairing.

## MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"State = government."**?

- A. Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156)
- B. Gauba treats it as incidental to sovereignty, not constitutive of statehood. (PDF p.152)
- C. Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF pp.157-158, 167)
- D. State means A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate.

**Answer: A**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "International recognition is an element of the state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Nation = state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'State means In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older meanings where it was equated with the state.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "State = government.", not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Civil society simply means NGOs."**?

- A. State means A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- B. NGOs are only one contemporary component; Gauba presents older, Hegelian, Marxian, Gramscian and associational meanings. (PDF pp.154-155, 173-176)
- C. Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF pp.157-158, 167)
- D. Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156); the rival mechanism is treated as non-decisive in this account.

**Answer: B**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'State means In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older meanings where it was equated with the state.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: NGOs are only one contemporary component; Gauba presents older, Hegelian, Marxian, Gramscian and associational meanings. (PDF pp.154-155, 173-176).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Nation = state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "State = government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Civil society simply means NGOs.", not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**Nation = state.**"?

- A. NGOs are only one contemporary component; Gauba presents older, Hegelian, Marxian, Gramscian and associational meanings. (PDF pp.154-155, 173-176)
- B. State means A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- C. Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF pp.157-158, 167)
- D. Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156)

**Answer: C**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Civil society simply means NGOs.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'State means In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older meanings where it was equated with the state.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF pp.157-158, 167).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "State = government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Nation = state.", not a different error from the same topic.

## MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: "**International recognition is an element of the state.**"?

- A. Government means Operating agency of the state; the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- B. Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156)
- C. Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF.
- D. Gauba treats it as incidental to sovereignty, not constitutive of statehood. (PDF p.152)

**Answer: D**

### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Government means The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "State = government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Nation = state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats it as incidental to sovereignty, not constitutive of statehood. (PDF p.152).

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "International recognition is an element of the state.", not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Indian secularism means equal approval of every religious practice."**?

- A. The second
- B. Its own feminist
- C. Government means Operating agency of.
- D. Gauba treats it as incidental to.

**Answer: A**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: The second.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Multiculturalism means all group practices are beyond criticism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Government means The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "International recognition is an element of the state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Indian secularism means equal approval of every, not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Multiculturalism means all group practices are beyond criticism."**?

- A. Gauba treats it as incidental to.
- B. Its own feminist
- C. Government means Operating agency of the.
- D. The second

**Answer: B**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "International recognition is an element of the state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Its own feminist.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Government means The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Indian secularism means equal approval of every religious practice.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about "Multiculturalism means all group practices are, not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **State means In contemporary usage, the sphere of associations and public activity outside direct state control; Gauba also presents older meanings where it was equated with the state.**?

- A. Gauba explicitly gives cases of nations without states and states lacking full national integration. (PDF pp.157-158, 167)
- B. NGOs are only one contemporary component; Gauba presents older, Hegelian, Marxian, Gramscian and associational meanings. (PDF pp.154-155, 173-176)
- C. State means A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- D. Government is only the administrative organ; the state is wider and more enduring. (PDF pp.151, 156); this option applies the proposition as a complete explanation.

**Answer: C**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Nation = state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Civil society simply means NGOs.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: State means A human community in a territory, governed by political authorities and armed with sovereignty and legitimate coercive power.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "State = government.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about State means In contemporary usage, the sphere of, not a different error from the same topic.

### MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Government means The supreme power of the state to make and enforce binding laws and decisions over population and territory.**?

- A. Its own feminist; this formulation is presented as sufficient for the classification.
- B. Gauba treats it as incidental to sovereignty.
- C. The second; this option applies the proposition as a complete explanation.
- D. Government means Operating agency of the state.

**Answer: D**

#### Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Multiculturalism means all group practices are beyond criticism.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "International recognition is an element of the state.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Indian secularism means equal approval of every religious practice.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Government means Operating agency of the state.

**Examiner trap:** Repair the exact overstatement about Government means The supreme power of the state to, not a different error from the same topic.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **State, Civil Society, Nation and Internationalism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

### ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

#### Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

**Question:** Distinguish state, government, society and nation. Why does the distinction matter? Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of state, government, society and nation. Why does the distinction matter in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, State, Core and Government, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that core analysis: The state is a territorially bounded public authority claiming sovereignty and legitimate coercion.

**Model answer (138 words):**

Introduction: State, government, society and nation overlap in political life but name different kinds of unity, authority and belonging. Core analysis: The state is a territorially bounded public authority claiming sovereignty and legitimate coercion. Government is its changeable operating machinery. Society is the wider web of relationships and associations through which people satisfy the full range of needs. A nation is a community joined by common political aspirations, history and a sense of shared destiny. A state may contain several nationalities, and a nation may exist without a sovereign state. Democratic criticism instead requires loyalty to constitutional order without obedience to every office-holder, while inclusive nationhood requires political unity without cultural uniformity. Conclusion: The distinction protects constitutional criticism, social plurality and inclusive nationhood by refusing to identify a temporary government or one culture with the whole political community.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, State, Core and Government), converts that evidence into analysis of state, government, society and nation. Why does the distinction matter, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that core analysis: The state is a territorially bounded public authority claiming sovereignty and legitimate coercion. At 138 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

---

#### Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

**Question:** Is civil society necessarily a sphere of freedom? Discuss with reference to Hegel, Marx, Gramsci and Tocqueville. Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive is requires the answer to take a side, defend it and concede the strongest point against it. Fix the boundary of civil society necessarily a sphere of freedom? Discuss with reference to Hegel, Marx, Gramsci and Tocqueville in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Civil, Core and Hegel, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that marx retained the economic location but argued that formally equal civil society reproduces capitalist class domination.

**Model answer (137 words):**

Introduction: Civil society is best treated as a contested arena rather than an automatically emancipatory space outside the state. Core analysis: Hegel distinguished civil society as the sphere of particular interests and economic dependence from the ethical universality claimed by the state. Marx retained the economic location but argued that formally equal civil society reproduces capitalist class domination. Gramsci widened the concept into schools, churches and cultural institutions where consent and hegemony are produced. Tocqueville, by contrast, saw voluntary associations as schools of democratic cooperation and counterweights to centralised power. Civil society is freedom-enhancing only when organisations are internally democratic, socially accessible and capable of challenging both state coercion and market domination. Conclusion: Civil society is a democratic possibility, not a guaranteed freedom-zone: its value depends on whether association counters or reproduces coercive, economic and ideological

power.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys is instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Civil, Core and Hegel), converts that evidence into analysis of civil society necessarily a sphere of freedom? Discuss with reference to Hegel, Marx, Gramsci and Tocqueville, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that marx retained the economic location but argued that formally equal civil society reproduces capitalist class domination. At 137 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

---

### Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

**Question:** How does nationalism differ from nationality, and can it coexist with internationalism? Answer in 150 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of does nationalism differ from nationality, and can it coexist with internationalism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Nationality, Core and Nationalism, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Nationalism and internationalism can coexist when national self-government remains civic and plural while accepting reciprocal restraints required by common human interests.

**Model answer (143 words):**

Introduction: Nationality is principally a consciousness of collective unity, whereas nationalism turns that consciousness into a political claim about self-rule, statehood or public priority. Core analysis: Nationality may grow from language, history, culture, territory or shared aspiration without requiring an existing sovereign state. Nationalism seeks to organise political power around the nation and can support anti-colonial freedom, democratic solidarity and welfare obligations. Internationalism begins from a different scale: common human interests require cooperation, institutions and reasonable restraints on unilateral sovereignty. Modern states may therefore combine national organisation with international commitments rather than choosing one orientation absolutely. Further development: The conceptual distinction becomes clearer through cases. Conflict arises when nationalism treats identity as homogeneous, sovereignty as unlimited or outsiders as permanently inferior. Conclusion: Nationalism and internationalism can coexist when national self-government remains civic and plural while accepting reciprocal restraints required by common human interests.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Nationality, Core and Nationalism), converts that evidence into analysis of does nationalism differ from nationality, and can it coexist with internationalism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Nationalism and internationalism can coexist when national self-government remains civic and plural while accepting reciprocal restraints required by common human interests. At 143 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

---

### Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

**Question:** Critically examine Robert Putnam's social-capital account of civil society and democratic performance. Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine Robert Putnam's social-capital account of civil society and democratic performance in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Putnam, Core and Italian, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that critical evaluation: The causal claim remains difficult because effective government may itself create trust and association.

**Model answer (240 words):**

Introduction: Putnam gives civil society an empirical democratic mechanism: repeated association can create trust, reciprocity and capacities for collective action. Core analysis: In his comparison of Italian regional governments, dense horizontal networks such as cooperatives, clubs and cultural associations were associated with more responsive institutions. In Bowling Alone he used declining participation to diagnose weakened civic connectedness. The theory explains why identical constitutional designs can perform differently: institutions depend on habits and relationships that formal rules alone cannot create. It also converts a normative defence of association into testable propositions about institutional performance. Further development: Putnam's distinction between bonding and bridging networks should govern the evaluation. Bonding ties can provide solidarity and mutual aid while intensifying exclusion,

patronage or sectarian closure; bridging ties connect citizens across social divisions and are more plausibly related to generalised trust. Institutional design also matters because transparent administration and fair public services can generate civic confidence rather than merely consume a pre-existing cultural stock. Social capital should therefore be analysed as a reciprocal relationship between associations, equality and institutions. Critical evaluation: The causal claim remains difficult because effective government may itself create trust and association. Putnam is strongest when networks are disaggregated by power, inclusion and direction of causation instead of being treated as an unqualified civic good. Conclusion: Social capital is politically valuable only after asking whose trust is produced, whether networks bridge difference, and whether association causes rather than merely accompanies institutional success.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Putnam, Core and Italian), converts that evidence into analysis of examine Robert Putnam's social-capital account of civil society and democratic performance, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that critical evaluation: The causal claim remains difficult because effective government may itself create trust and association. At 240 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

---

### Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

**Question:** Explain Cohen and Arato's reconstruction of civil society as a distinct third sphere. Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of Cohen and Arato's reconstruction of civil society as a distinct third sphere in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Cohen, Arato and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Their third-sphere model is most convincing as an account of differentiated but mediated autonomy, not as a claim that state, market and civil society are empirically sealed compartments.

**Model answer (239 words):**

Introduction: Cohen and Arato reconstruct civil society as a differentiated sphere of associations, publics, movements and culture irreducible to both state administration and market exchange. Core analysis: Their model explains why feminist, environmental and human-rights movements cannot be located adequately in either a state-centred or market-centred vocabulary. Civil society protects communicative autonomy, but it reaches binding decisions through political society, including parties and legislatures, and affects production through an economically regulated sphere that includes markets and trade unions. Mediation is necessary: autonomy does not mean isolation, and social movements need channels that translate claims into law and policy without absorbing them into the state. Further development: The model also clarifies the difference between influence and command. Civil-society actors normally persuade, publicise and organise rather than issue binding law. Political society converts some claims into authorised decisions, while economic society translates others into regulated bargaining and production. This division protects movement autonomy but creates a representation problem: professional mediators may displace participants, and access to parties, media and legislatures is unequal. A complete account must therefore examine both the autonomy of claim formation and the democratic quality of institutional transmission. Critical evaluation: The reconstruction restores precision against equating civil society with NGOs alone. The spheres are analytically distinct but empirically interdependent. Conclusion: Their third-sphere model is most convincing as an account of differentiated but mediated autonomy, not as a claim that state, market and civil society are empirically sealed compartments.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Cohen, Arato and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of Cohen and Arato's reconstruction of civil society as a distinct third sphere, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Their third-sphere model is most convincing as an account of differentiated but mediated autonomy, not as a claim that state, market and civil society are empirically sealed compartments. At 239 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

---

## Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

**Question:** Does Marcuse's one-dimensional society eliminate the emancipatory potential of civil society? Answer in 250 words.

**Demand decode:** the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of Marcuse's one-dimensional society eliminate the emancipatory potential of civil society in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Marcuse's, Core and Advanced, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Marcuse establishes the danger of manufactured consent and absorbed dissent, but the history of counter-movements prevents that danger from becoming a total theory of social closure.

**Model answer (238 words):**

Introduction: Marcuse's one-dimensionality thesis warns that associational plurality can coexist with a deep closure of critical consciousness. Core analysis: Advanced industrial society, he argues, integrates opposition by manufacturing needs, organising mass consumption and directing dissatisfaction into administrable forms. Repressive desublimation permits controlled satisfactions while weakening the critical distance from existing society. Formally independent media and associations may therefore reproduce dominant rationality instead of resisting it. The thesis challenges the liberal inference that the mere existence of non-state organisations proves autonomy or freedom. Further development: Marcuse's argument is strongest when read as a mechanism of depoliticisation. Consumer satisfaction, technological rationality and standardised communication can narrow the imaginable alternatives even without direct censorship. Yet needs are never perfectly manufactured, social contradictions continue to generate grievances, and institutions cannot fully control how citizens reinterpret dominant messages. Counter-publics, oppositional art and social movements reopen critical distance. The resulting judgment is conditional: advanced society can absorb resistance, but absorption is a contested achievement rather than an irreversible structural law. Critical evaluation: The argument risks becoming self-sealing because every apparent dissent can be redescribed as managed integration. Civil-rights, feminist, environmental and anti-war movements demonstrate that associations can still generate counter-publics and institutional change. Marcuse identifies a permanent danger of capture, not proof that emancipatory mobilisation is impossible. Conclusion: Marcuse establishes the danger of manufactured consent and absorbed dissent, but the history of counter-movements prevents that danger from becoming a total theory of social closure.

**Why this earns marks:** it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Marcuse's, Core and Advanced), converts that evidence into analysis of Marcuse's one-dimensional society eliminate the emancipatory potential of civil society, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Marcuse establishes the danger of manufactured consent and absorbed dissent, but the history of counter-movements prevents that danger from becoming a total theory of social closure. At 238 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

---